

loan on top of that, and it's easy to see why so many find starting a business intimidating.

Brad and Jonathan applied lean start-up principles to *ChooseFI*. They spent a few dollars for a web domain and bought a couple of microphones. Then they used their laptops and sweat equity to get their business off the ground. When you take this approach to business and life, you have tremendous freedom to try new things without taking a financial risk, even if you are still early on the road to FI. If *ChooseFI* had crashed and burned, Jonathan would have been all right. Nobody wants to fail, and it wouldn't have been fun, but no one would have been knocking on his door to repossess his car or collect other debts. He would have probably just been heading back to a pharmacy job, and he'd have had the satisfaction of knowing he tried. If you try and it doesn't work out, you haven't failed, you've just gained a learning experience. Framed that way, his decision wasn't very risky at all.

Jonathan

You realize the benefits of FI long before you reach FI. We call this a fully funded lifestyle change (FFLC), and this is really my story. I got my expenses down to the bone and paid